Aran Ramakrishnan

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Education

University of California, San Diego — San Diego, CA
B.S. Computer Science — *Expected June 2028*

University of California, Santa Cruz — Santa Cruz, CA
B.S. Computer Science (Transferred out) | GPA: 3.93 | Regent Merit Scholar — *2024-2026*
Relevant Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Machine Learning, Principles of Computer Systems Design, Systems Programming and Software Tools, Probability Theory, Linear Algebra

Experience

AI Development Intern (KDE) — July 2026 – August 2026
Remitly — *Seattle, WA*

- Cut annual spend by **$30k** by automating mentorship matching, using LLM-assisted scoring with human-in-the-loop moderation (Go, DynamoDB, React, Kubernetes)
- Led an observational causal inference study of ∼**800k** cross-border payments customers, using Trino SQL and Python to estimated counterfactual churn by controlling for pre-treatment confounders. Examined treatments such as identity verification (KYC) and price changes. Found each was associated with about **5 percentage points** higher churn

AI/ML Researcher — Sept 2025 – Present
Neuromorphic Computing Group — *Santa Cruz, CA*

- **First-authored** the paper "Cross-User Adaptation for sEMG Gesture Recognition via Continual Learning" accepted to the 2026 **IEEE Biomedical Circuits and Systems Conference** (available December 2026)
- Benchmarked **3** continual learning (CL) approaches on class-incremental and domain-incremental settings on the NinaPro Dataset, to improve model adaptation for prosthetic control, using HGRN and LSTM base models
- Showed replay reaches **83.3%** final accuracy with forgetting held to **1.8%** versus **16–28%** for EWC; traced a training collapse to batch ordering rather than recurrent state via a **2×2 ablation**

GTM Engineering Intern — April 2026 – July 2026
Smart Sentry AI — *Sunnyvale, CA*

- Sourced over **10k** leads resulting in **150** customer meetings
- Built an LLM-powered lead generation tool that integrates with existing CRM workflows, cutting manual prospecting and outreach time by ∼**80%**
- Increased reply rates by **20%** by sorting customer leads into segments and tagging each lead with signals like recent LinkedIn activity and email availability to automate outreach channel selection and message drafting

NLP Researcher — Jul 2025 – Jan 2026
SlothLab — *Santa Cruz, CA*

- Fine-tuned and benchmarked **4 transformer** models (BERT, DistilBERT, RoBERTa, DeBERTa-v3) across **12** LoRA configurations for named entity recognition on CoNLL-2003, reaching **95.0%** validation F1 while training **99.68%** fewer parameters than full fine-tuning
- Used the best model in an automated pipeline that extracts characters from **100+** LLM-generated stories to check if long stories maintain consistency, finding that side characters are often dropped while keeping the main plot is kept intact

Projects & Ventures

Symphony (Co-founder) | *MCP, LLMs, React* — Mar 2026 – Present

- **Won $2k in seed funding** at 2026 Santa Cruz Launchpad, invited to Berkeley Skydeck
- Built the **ingestion and fully customizable analytics layer** giving engineers visibility into AI coding agents (tracking prompt volume, token usage, and separate model costs)

Skills

Languages: Python, Go (Golang), TypeScript, JavaScript, C++, C, Java, SQL
Frameworks: React, Next.js, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, scikit-learn, snnTorch
ML/AI: LLM APIs, AI agents, LoRA, PEFT, MCP, NLP, RAG, named entity recognition, regression, deep learning
Data/Stats: Pandas, NumPy, Trino, causal inference, A/B testing, statistical analysis
Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, DynamoDB, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Linux, REST APIs, CI/CD, Git